

politics around the world. Each house confers unique strengths and weaknesses on its members, which are magically bestowed by initiation into its ranks, and each possesses its own values, culture, and expectations for its members. Full writeups of each house are provided in Chapter Two.

You do not need to be of the same court as a house's affiliation to be a member — there are Unseelie Gwydion, for instance, as well as Seelie Ailil — though life can be difficult for such mavericks. If your character does not have a title, simply write “unaffiliated” in this space. Note that playing a noble requires the Title Background; see Step Three for details.

Step Two: Traits

This step of character creation involves assigning values to Traits, which reflect a character's innate capabilities as well as things she has learned over time. At each stage you are allocated a certain number of points to spend, which means you will have to prioritize what is most important for your character. It is very likely that you may not be able to purchase everything you want right away, but don't worry! Later on you will be able to spend freebie points to purchase more Traits, and of course you can also purchase them with experience points during play. Focus on what is most essential first, and worry about other elements later.

Attributes

A character's *Attributes* measure her innate characteristics; while they can be improved with effort, they reflect a baseline level of aptitude. Attributes are divided into three categories: *Physical*, *Social*, and *Mental*, reflecting three different core aspects of a character.

Physical: These Traits measure a character's raw power, agility, and toughness. A character who excels at athletics, combat, or the performing arts is likely to have good scores in these Traits.

Social: Social Attributes determine how magnetic, expressive, and attractive a character is. If you want your character to talk her way out of trouble, play political games, or just turn heads wherever she goes, these are the Traits to focus on.

Mental: Your character's Mental Attributes govern how intelligent she is, how much she notices about her surroundings, and how quickly she reacts to changing events. Scholars, investigators, and tricksters alike find focusing on these Traits a necessity to get ahead.

Before allocating points to Attributes, you must prioritize the three categories, selecting one to be your strongest, another to be your next strongest, and a third category to be your weakest. This is an important decision, as Attributes form the foundation of many rolls in the game as well as reflect where your character's natural strengths and weaknesses lie. This priority reflects how many points you have to spend in a particular category.

Once you have prioritized your Attribute categories, you may begin spending points to purchase “dots” in the Traits listed in each category. Each point buys one dot.



Attribute Points



Primary: You may allocate 7 points among the Traits listed under your primary Attribute category.

Secondary: You may allocate 5 points among the Traits listed under your secondary Attribute category.

Tertiary: You may allocate 3 points among the Traits listed under your tertiary Attribute category.



Every character receives one dot in each Attribute for free, representing the minimum level most characters can possess. A character cannot have a rating of zero in an Attribute unless powerful magic or extreme circumstance somehow utterly removes that capability, such as a paralyzed character losing all Dexterity. Note that you can go back and change your Attribute allocations later on during character creation if your image of your character changes, but for now it's good to have something to go on as you go forward in the process.

Abilities

If Attributes are innate characteristics, then *Abilities* measure skills and aptitudes a character has picked up over her life. Abilities are further divided into *Talents*, *Skills*, and *Knowledges*.

Talents: These Abilities are largely intuitive, and usually cannot be formally trained beyond the most rudimentary understanding. They are simply something a person possesses, though experience can certainly help refine their technique.

Skills: In this category you can find aptitudes based on hands-on training and technical knowledge, which are typically improved through applied use and simple practice.

Knowledges: Abilities in this category most often reflect classical “book learning,” whether through formal instruction or a casual mentor relationship. Some can be self-taught, but most require extensive mental ability, resources, and instruction to acquire.

Just as with Attributes, the three categories must be prioritized. You must select one category to be your strongest (primary), your average (secondary), and your weakest (tertiary). After priority has been assigned, you may begin spending points in



Ability Points



Primary: You may allocate 13 points among the Traits listed under your primary Ability category.

Secondary: You may allocate 9 points among the Traits listed under your secondary Ability category.

Tertiary: You may allocate 5 points among the Traits listed under your tertiary Ability category.

